

Microsoft offers up to US\$ 100,000 to hack its custom Linux OS



Tech giant Microsoft is offering hackers up to US\$ 100,000 if they can break the security of the company's custom Linux OS. The company had built a compact and custom version of Linux for its Azure Sphere OS last year, which is designed to run on specialised chips for its Internet of Things (IoT) platform. The OS has been purpose-built for this platform to enable basic services and apps to run isolated in a sandbox for security purposes.

Sylvie Liu, a security programme manager at Microsoft's Security Response Centre, said that the company will award a bounty of up to US\$ 100,000 if the Pluton security subsystem or the Secure World sandbox is breached in the Azure Sphere OS. The bug bounty programme is part of a three-month research challenge that runs from June 1 until August 31.

Microsoft said that the challenge is focused on the Azure Sphere OS itself, and not on the underlying cloud portion that's already eligible for Azure bounty programme awards. Azure Sphere was announced at last year's Build developer conference.

Eclipse Foundation moves to Europe as part of its continued global expansion

The Eclipse Foundation has announced that in order to expand globally, it is establishing itself as a Europe based organisation. It said that through the creation of Eclipse Foundation AISBL based in Brussels, it will be in a position to use its recent international growth and bring about global industry collaboration on open source projects in strategic technologies. These include the cloud, edge computing, artificial intelligence, connected vehicles, telecommunications, and the Internet of Things. The establishment of the new legal entity is expected to be finalised by July 2020.

The Foundation said that it recognises the important role open source will play in driving the digital and industrial transformations called for by the European Commission in its recent strategies. It added that contributions from a broad

GitHub and Major League Hacking announce remote open source internship initiative

GitHub and Major League Hacking (MLH) have set up the MLH Fellowship. This remote internship programme will support the next generation of developers with open source projects. Facebook, Royal Bank of Canada and DEV have already signed on as supporters and sponsors.

Mike Swift, CEO of MLH said, "Enabling students to spend their summer contributing to the software that runs the world is a unique opportunity for them. They'll work on meaningful projects with their peers, under the guidance of some of the world's most talented engineers. The remote nature of this programme will democratise access to internships for countless students worldwide."



The programme will be for a 12-week period and will run through the summer. It will train up to 1,000 students full time on major open source projects under the mentorship of experienced engineers. The students will work in 'pods' of eight to ten students with open source projects and mentors. They will receive a stipend for the programme through GitHub sponsors.